

Μάτρων ὁ Πιτανεύς

## Matron of Pitane and the Parody of Homeric Feasting

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**Period:** *Κλασική* Classical  
**Dialect:** *Ἑπική* Epic (Homeric)  
**Domain:** *Ποίησις* Poetry  
**Format:** *Ἑμμετρος* Verse

Matron of Pitane was a Greek parodist from the city of Pitane in Aeolis, active in the late 5th or early 4th century BCE. His biography is almost entirely unknown, preserved solely through Athenaeus's **Deipnosophistae** from the 2nd–3rd century CE, which identifies his origin and quotes his work.

His sole known work is **The Attic Dinner**, a lengthy hexameter poem that parodies Homeric epic style to describe an extravagant Athenian banquet. Over 100 lines survive via quotation in Athenaeus.

Matron is a master of literary parody, using the elevated diction and meter of epic to humorously depict a gluttonous feast, creating a deliberate and sophisticated dissonance. His work provides valuable, if satirical, insight into Classical Athenian dining culture and stands as one of the most substantial examples of ancient Greek parody to survive.

### Works (3)

- [Δεῖπνον Ἀττικόν](#) · Attic Banquet · 122 passages
- [Δεῖπνον Ἀττικόν](#) · Attic Banquet · 16 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · Banquet of Xenocles · 95 passages